masquerading as the N.C.E.R.T. books.[11] The façade of being the epitome of greatness built around the deeds of Alexander, Ashoka[‡] and Akbar[12] simply crumbled, exposing the mundane monochromatic brutal character they all owned. Of all, the two very important aspects that touched me deeply were —'neither freedom made a walk-in without any dragger or shield[13], nor was Tipu Sulṭān the first freedom fighter[*] as told'.

India's recent colonialists'[†] loyalists manhandled our past the most.[14] While taking up the responsibility of writing our history, they not only covered up the deeds of the European colonialists but also veiled past colonialists like Tīmūrids.[15] Interestingly, the latter have been very honest about their deeds and all the *-namas* shrink our hearts with descriptions of the worst kind of atrocities they inflicted upon our ancestors.[16] In their eyes, atrocities upon the *kafirs* (disbelievers/infidels) were virtuous, hence they saw no harm in flaunting it.[17] Not many would know that the records also exist wherein religious leaders in the time of Akbar lament the *Padishah* becoming softer towards the Hindus in the latter phase of his reign.[18]

After Jawaharlal Nehru waved a see-off to them in August of 1947, our stories began to turn more problematic than earlier. A brigade of intellectuals came into being who reinforced the 'culture disparaging projects'[*] by initiating the task of popularizing the fictional narratives of the 'Aryan Invasion', [19] which later matured as 'Aryan Migration'.[†] Narratives were woven stating that Britishers gave us the great language, with which we use in the world and it could tie India together.[20] [‡] The narrative-weavers also said that we were given the boon of 'rail', but none said that it was the infrastructure crafted to boost their economic benefits and neither were we told how this project of railway led to the invitation of the disastrous disease called malaria.[§] We were told that Bhagat Singh was not a revolutionary but a terrorist and so were his comrades in the cause. The family of legend *Hutatma* Bhagat Singh had to appeal to the government of the day to disassociate the word 'terrorist' from Bhagat Singh in textbooks.[*]

As Rajiv Malhotra says, the *Grand Narrative* needs to be established and it will be done by numerous intellectuals over several years.[†]

It has taken some decades, but the same band of intellectuals also popularized the narrative that Vinayak Damodar Savarkar wasn't a '*Veer* Patriot' but a 'Petition-Writing Servant of British'. Unfortunately, not many giant attempts were made to vaporize the odour of these tarnishes. But then came one of the